Committee: Economic and Social Council (ECOSOC)

Topic: The Question of Integrating Smart Infrastructure into Urban Planning for Sustainable Development

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Introduction

During the past few decades, traditional urban planning and rapid urbanization have caused significant environmental and socioeconomic challenges. Critically, traditional urban planning is largely dependent on non-renewable energy, which reduces the resilience of urban systems and accelerates the climate crisis. On the other hand, smart infrastructure includes advanced technologies that provide the most efficient methods to address global issues. Furthermore, modern cities also face a compounding crisis of systemic inefficiency, digital exclusion, and spatial inequality. For instance, according to the International Journal of Research (IJRC) 2025 and Nature Communications 2025, aging water networks leak up to 30% of treated water before it reaches consumers, while traditional power grids show significant transmission losses accounting for up to 68.1%. Moreover, one result of spatial inequality is the emergence of infrastructure deserts in low-income and rural regions. Vulnerable populations are trapped in mobility poverty and are unable to access economic opportunities due to the lack of data-driven public services and flexible transit. In addition to these examples, past urban planning without smart infrastructure faced various challenges that negatively impacted the quality of urban life and the environment.

Against this background, nations are working to integrate smart infrastructure into their urban planning. To be specific, smart infrastructure includes advanced technologies like AI data analytics, intelligent transportation systems, eco-friendly buildings, and other technologies that enhance the community's infrastructure and communication, also mitigating environmental pollution and human-caused damage. For instance, smart water management systems use IoT sensors to detect leaks in real time, addressing the inefficiencies of aging water networks, while intelligent transportation systems help reduce mobility poverty by optimizing transit routes for underserved communities.

Moreover, there are many more benefits for nations to integrate smart infrastructure, such as smart grids that reduce energy losses and facilitate renewable energy integration. AI-based disaster prediction systems enable citizens to prepare for events.

However, while smart infrastructure offers numerous advantages it also leaves challenges that nations need to address. Specifically, there are four main challenges that should be solved to fully adapt smart infrastructure to each city. Firstly, implementing smart infrastructure requires high expenses. Since smart infrastructure utilizes highly advanced technologies and systems it is complicated to install and difficult to maintain constantly, which places a significant financial burden especially on developing nations or nations with limited budgets. Secondly, the extensive use of sensors and data collection systems raises serious concerns about data privacy and cybersecurity. Since smart infrastructure relies on continuously collecting and analyzing citizens' personal data, it creates possibilities for hacking and misuse of sensitive data. Thirdly, smart infrastructure risks deepening the digital divide, as elderly citizens, low-income households, and residents in rural areas may lack the digital literacy or access to devices needed to benefit from those technologies. Therefore, it potentially excludes vulnerable populations from the services designed to benefit all citizens. Lastly, integrating multiple smart systems such as transportation, energy, and water management into a single network requires high levels of technical expertise, and the lack of compatibility between systems might block the systems from working properly. In addition to these challenges, national governments are recently confronting many other challenges.

Despite these challenges, the benefits of smart infrastructure make it a necessary direction for future urban development. Financial and technical barriers to smart infrastructure are hard for individual nations to overcome. Therefore, international cooperation, through knowledge sharing, joint research, and financial support for developing countries is essential. Also, the national government must structure a policy to address challenges mentioned above.

Ultimately, while smart infrastructure is inevitable for sustainable urban development, the main challenges are whether cities can bridge the gap between technological innovation and economic equity. The fundamental challenges, which are high costs, cybersecurity threats, digital exclusion, and technical fragmentation, must be addressed to prevent smart cities from becoming exclusive privilege for certain citizens, thereby deepening inequality.

Definition of Key Terms

Smart City

A smart city is an urban development using Information and Communication Technology (ICT) and Internet of Things (IoT) to provide useful information to effectively manage resources and assets. This includes data collected from citizens and mechanical devices that are processed and analyzed to monitor and manage traffic and transport systems, power plants, water supply networks, and waste disposal. For instance, in South Korea, Songdo International Business District (Songdo IBD) is the most popular example of smart cities that directly improves the quality of life by creating green spaces, business hubs, and sustainable designs. Smart cities have been promoted in order to enhance citizens' lives and mitigate the environmental crisis that is currently worsening. Moreover, smart cities play a role as a community that actually assists citizens in accessing intelligent transportation systems and high-quality services. For example, Songdo IBD shows the highest concentration of LEED (Leadership in Energy and Environmental Design) certified buildings, which means Songdo IBD is a place designed to be eco-friendly.

Urban Planning

Urban planning is the process of designing and organizing how towns and cities are built in order to establish eco-friendly buildings and advanced technical infrastructure. Historically, urban planning has mainly focused on physical design but modern urban planning has expanded into a strategic framework that manages land use, transit networks, and public resources. Modern urban planning adopted not only energy-efficient strategies but also eco-friendly strategies. For example, as previously mentioned, Songdo IBD is a symbol of modern urban planning. It has implemented smart environmental infrastructure, transportation infrastructure, disaster management, smart living, and eco-friendly smart buildings based on AI data analytics strategy. These kinds of infrastructure help citizens to improve their quality of life. On the other hand, past urban planning has heavily relied on physical designs, so it has fostered environmental pollution and the disparities in facilities.

Smart Governance

Smart governance utilizes modern digital technologies such as Information and Communication Technologies (ICT) to promote e-participation, open data, digital Public Services, data-driven decision making, transparency and accountability. These elements aim to shift governance from a top-down model to one that is more responsive, transparent, and citizen-centered, allowing citizens to actively participate in policymaking rather than being passive recipients of government decisions. For example, Singapore is currently implementing the Smart Nation project, specifically launched to organize and integrate digital technologies, sensors, big data, and artificial intelligence, for enhancing economic productivity, improving public service delivery, and strengthening social cohesion. For these advantages, smart governance is becoming a trend among the international community.

Information and Communication Technologies (ICT)

Information and Communication Technologies (ICT) referss to the various tools and platforms that facilitate the exchange of information among individuals and groups. This covers a wide range of devices, applications, and networks. Effective and accessible ICT can foster inclusive digital transformation in society. Also, ICT makes the change of communication by altering the methods in the way of digital technologies. Because of this, ICT is a significant technology to create smart governance. Therefore, nations are attempting to adopt ICT technologies and Estonia is a great example of it. It is adopting ICT to promote effective management by utilizing digital identity, data integration platform, e-government portal, digital business registry, and cybersecurity infrastructure.

Digital Governance

Digital governance refers to how governments, organisations, and civil society make decisions and manage actions in the digital world. Generally, digital governance is adopted by utilizing ICT that is mentioned above. For example, in Estonia, 100 percent of Estonia's government services are now available online, and its X-Road platform connects databases across sectors such as healthcare, taxation, and education. These technologies not only improve citizens' quality of life by enabling more efficient communication but also reduce administrative costs and processing time for citizens and businesses alike. Furthermore, digital governance allows citizens to actively participate in politics.

Internet of Things (IoT)

Internet of Things (IoT) is a system of interrelated computing devices, mechanical and digital machines, objects, animals or people that are provided with unique identifiers and the ability to transfer data over a network without requiring human-to-human or human-to-computer interaction. Examples include the control of lights, air conditioning systems, smart grids, intelligent transportation systems, or wearable health devices, among others. These kinds of systems can be controlled from a remote location and they are automatically connected to send their data for analysis. To be specific, China has implemented IoT integration into urban infrastructure. In Hangzhou, Alibaba's "City Brain" platform uses AI and connected IoT sensors to analyze real-time traffic data, automatically adjusting traffic signals to reduce congestion.

Relationship between ICT and IoT

While ICT and IoT are closely related, they refer to different aspects of the digital transformation. ICT is the broader concept, utilizing the wide range of tools, platforms, and networks that enable the exchange of information among people, such as Estonia's digital identity systems and e-government portals. However, IoT refers specifically to the network of physical devices and sensors that are connected to each other and transmit data automatically without human controls, such as in the case of Shenzhen's environmental monitoring systems. In other words, ICT focuses on human to system communication, while IoT focuses on machine to machine communication between physical objects. Therefore, IoT can be understood as one specific application of ICT. Together, these two technologies form the technical basis of smart governance and smart infrastructure.

Renewable Energy

Renewable energy is energy derived from natural sources that are replenished at a higher rate than they are consumed. For example, sunlight and wind are such sources that are constantly being replenished. To be specific, Germany is a leading example of renewable energy growth. According to the IEA, through its national energy policy called Energiewende, Germany plans to produce 80% of its electricity from renewable sources by 2030 and 100% by 2035. Currently, Germany has already made significant progress toward this goal, with 10.8 GW of offshore wind power currently in

operation as of 2026. To support this growth, Germany is also building smart grid systems that help transmit and manage renewable electricity across the country.

Digital Divide

The digital divide is a gap between individuals or groups who have access to digital technologies and those who don't have access to those. This kind of gap exists not only in physical access to devices and the internet, which is called access divide but also in the ability to use these technologies effectively, which is called usage divide and quality divide. For example, elderly citizens or residents in rural areas often don't have opportunities to be educated to utilize digital technologies and high quality infrastructure to benefit them from smart infrastructure. As a result, the digital divide has a serious challenge that it might be excluding vulnerable populations from the very services designed to improve their quality of life.

Data Governance Framework

A data governance framework is a set of rules and processes that guide how an organization manages its data. It ensures that data stays accurate, secure, and used properly. To be specific, these frameworks typically define who is responsible for managing data, how it should be protected, and how it should be utilized. For instance, Singapore's government uses a data governance framework under its Public Sector Act, allowing them to share data with each other for public services like healthcare and welfare support. This helps citizens receive support automatically and conveniently. Also it helps the government to effectively participate in their role of managing the nation.

Background Information

Historical Background of Advent Smart City

Modern urbanization features can be traced back to the Industrial Revolution of the late 18th century, when factories were rapidly established and populations were speedily growing. This shift has brought a huge economic growth, but it also brought significant challenges, including pollution, poor sanitation, and a dangerous work environment. Throughout the 20th century, this trend of expansion continued, particularly as transportation development led to the expansion of road networks and highways.

Against this background, the conceptual origins of the smart city emerged much earlier than commonly assumed. In 1974, the Los Angeles Community Analysis Bureau used early computers to build a database of social and physical data across the city, showing one of the earliest attempts to apply digital analysis to urban management.

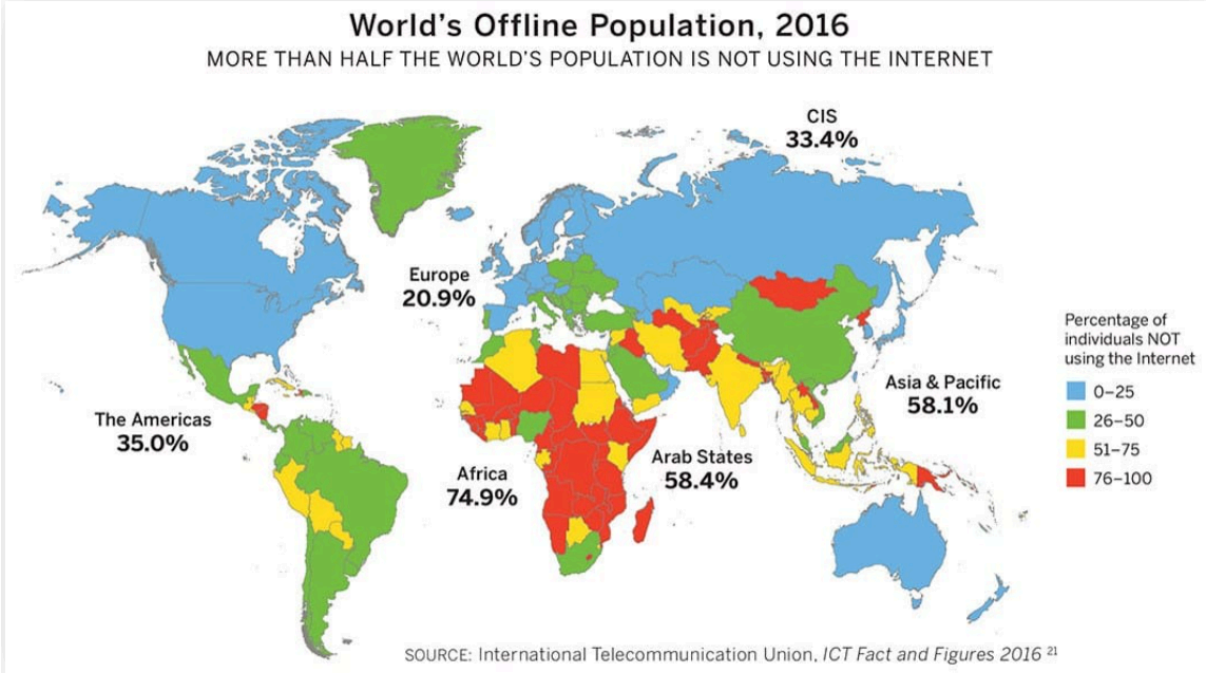
More recently technological developments such as artificial intelligence(AI), big data, and the Internet of Things have allowed governments to design smart cities aiming to solve the comprehensive challenges. Furthermore, these developments have enabled the nations to set a goal of integrating smart infrastructure into urban planning

The Relationship Between Smart Infrastructure and Sustainable Development

As climate change is rising as a critical issue and the environmental crisis is accelerating, the need for smart infrastructure has been of interest among the nations. Smart infrastructure and sustainable development are fundamentally interconnected, since smart infrastructure gives us the technology to reach those goals. Sustainable development sets the goal of achieving a lasting balance between environmental, economic, and social needs, while smart infrastructure provides the technological means to achieve that goal more effectively. In terms of environmental sustainability, technologies such as smart grids and IoT-based water management systems reduce resource waste and facilitate the integration of renewable energy. Economically, smart infrastructure lowers operational and maintenance costs by enabling more efficient use of resources. Also by looking at Estonia's digital government systems It has significantly reduced administrative expenses and processing time through the datafication and automation of public administrative frameworks. Socially, smart governance

promotes citizen participation and more equitable access to public services, which strengthens the urban communications.

Against this background, they are still concerned about the negative impacts. Without careful governance and detailed policy design, smart infrastructure can bring challenges such as digital divide. As mentioned above, digital divide is a concept that excludes vulnerable populations such as elderly citizens, low-income population, and rural residents from those benefits provided by smart infrastructure. Since the access to devices is limited and also their digital literacy skills are often insufficient to fully adapt. This suggests that integrating smart infrastructure into urban planning requires careful consideration, which requires a thoughtful combination of technological innovation.



International Telecommunication Union (ICT Fact and Figures, 2016)

Current Situation of Nations that are Integrating Smart Infrastructure

Several nations have already established themselves as leaders in integrating smart infrastructure into urban planning and each nation has a distinct strategy. South Korea's Songdo IBD represents a top-down approach, built entirely by the government. Estonia and Singapore have taken a national digital approach, applying digital government systems. Furthermore, China has implemented a large-scale smart city, most notably Hangzhou's City Brain and Shenzhen's IoT based green

infrastructure, while Germany has concentrated on integrating renewable energy with smart grid systems, and the United States has advanced smart transportation and digital infrastructure.

Beyond these established leaders, several emerging regions are rapidly increasing their efforts to integrate smart infrastructure. The UAE and Saudi Arabia have become major hubs for smart urban development by investing heavily in Dubai and NEOM. To be more specific, NEOM is a region in the making in northwest Saudi Arabia, conceived to support the diversification of the nation's economy and create new urban solutions. India has also emerged as a significant nation through its nationwide Smart Cities Missions such as AI based metro systems. Also, in Africa, countries such as Kenya have started to launch smart city pilot projects.

These example illustrates that integration of smart infrastructure into urban planning has become a global trend. Also, nations around the world are trying to integrate those infrastructure to reap economic, environmental, governmental benefits. Furthermore, through the process of integrating, nations are also focusing on advanced technologies.

On the other hand, integrating smart infrastructure into urban planning has also revealed several problems. Despite being evaluated as an advanced smart city, Songdo IBD has struggled with a low population inflow, as many residents found the city expensive and lacking a sense of community. In China, the large-scale surveillance systems used in projects like Hangzhou's City Brain have raised significant concerns about data privacy and government oversight. Furthermore, developing regions such as Kenya face challenges related to limited funding and insufficient digital infrastructure, making it difficult to fully adopt their smart city projects. Also, the high cost of implementing technologies has deepened the gap between wealthy nations and developing nations, which raises the concerns about unequal access to smart infrastructure.

Relevant UN Involvement and International Framework

The international community has recognized the importance of sustainable urbanization through several key frameworks. SDG 11, adopted by the UN General Assembly in 2015 as a part of the 2030 Agenda calls for ensuring access to safe and affordable housing and sustainable transport systems. Since the SDG 11 is designed to be connected, it is directly related to the goals concerning energy, transportation and industry.

Based on this, the New Urban Agenda was adopted at the UN conference on housing and sustainable urban development in Quito, Ecuador, in October 2016. Also later approved by the UN General Assembly. This document serves as the first international agreement detailing how the nations would implement the changes, outlining governance frameworks such as national urban policies and local financial support. Against this background, the New Urban Agenda plays a role to guide the nations to approach SDG 11 challenges and to translate it into national and local action, including relevance to smart infrastructure adoption.

UN-Habitat, the UN agency responsible for promoting sustainable human settlements has supported the implementation of both frameworks. It has provided technical assistance and policy guidance to smart city projects, especially in developing nations. Also, these frameworks show that integrating smart infrastructure into urban planning is a global priority. Furthermore, achieving this goal requires sustained international cooperation between developed and developing nations.

Possible Solutions

International Funding

As mentioned above, one of the main obstacles to integrating smart infrastructure is the high financial cost, which limits the developing nations to implement. International funding, such as loans and grants from organizations like the World Bank and regional development banks can help bridge this gap. Also, joint funding initiatives between developed and developing nations allow countries to overcome limited budgets and continue their implementation of smart infrastructure without depleting domestic resources. Furthermore, establishing international funds specifically for smart infrastructure projects could provide more consistent and long-term financial support, rather than relying on short-term, which tends to be inconsistent.

Sharing Technologies Between Nations

Technology sharing between nations can reduce the technical burden that developing nations are currently facing. Since countries like Estonia and China have already developed advanced digital governance and IoT systems, sharing their technical expertise and infrastructure models with developing nations can prevent those countries from wasting valuable time and resources.

This kind of cooperation also helps ensure that new systems are aligning with existing international standards, addressing technical fragmentation between different smart infrastructure systems. Technology sharing partnerships, such as joint research programs between nations, can accelerate the pace at which developing countries adopt smart infrastructure, while strengthening diplomatic and economic relationships between participating nations.

Addressing Digital Divide

Digital divide is a critical concern, since vulnerable populations such as elderly citizens, low-income households and rural residents often lack access to devices and digital literacy. Governments can address this by expanding public digital education programs and donating devices for low-income populations, ensuring that the benefits of smart infrastructure reach every citizen regardless of their economic status.

Ensuring that smart infrastructure services remain available through both digital and traditional ways can prevent the exclusion of citizens who are not yet digitally literate. Local governments could also establish community digital centers, where citizens can receive training and access to devices, particularly in rural or underserved areas where private access to technology remains limited

Structuring the Policy of Smart Infrastructure

National governments must establish clear policies and regulatory frameworks to guide the implementation of smart infrastructure. This includes setting data privacy standards to address cybersecurity concerns as well as establishing clear guidelines on how citizens' data can be collected, stored and used.

Structured policies also help ensure that smart infrastructure projects remain accountable and transparent, which builds public trust. Also, governments should regularly review and update these policies as new technologies emerge, ensuring that regulatory frameworks stay relevant and continue to protect citizens' rights and safety over time.

Public-Private Partnerships (PPP)

Public-private partnerships can help reduce the financial and technical burden while accelerating the implementation of smart infrastructure. By allowing private technology companies to invest and operate certain systems, such as smart grids and intelligent transportation networks, governments can share both the risks and the costs of large-scale projects. This approach has already proven effective in cities like Songdo, where private developers played a significant role in constructing and managing smart infrastructure.

Attracting Foreign Investment

Foreign Direct Investment (FDI) could be a solution to fund smart infrastructure. Unlike loans and funds from international organizations, FDI is a method in which foreign companies directly invest their own capital, bringing technology and experts along with money. This can help developing nations that are lacking domestic resources to build and control smart infrastructure on their own.

However, foreign investment also raises concerns. If one foreign company provides all the core technology of smart infrastructure, cities may only rely on it and find it expensive to switch companies. Foreign companies may also gain access to citizens' sensitive data. Therefore, governments should set clear regulations on data storage and access. Also make investment agreements public for transparency and require technology transfer and clear maintenance responsibilities to ensure sustainability.

Major Parties Involved

International Telecommunication Union

The International Telecommunication Union (ITU) is the UN specialized agency that deals with information and communication technology. Also, it serves as a driving force behind the global transition to smart sustainable cities, fostering collaboration, capacity building, policy development, and awareness-raising to ensure a people-centered approach to urban transformation. By its Study Group 20, ITU develops standards, guidelines, and further enhances the Internet of Things, digital twins and smart infrastructure to promote digital transformation in both urban and rural regions. Furthermore, ITU coordinates the United for Smart Sustainable Cities (U4SSC) initiative with UN-Habitat and the UN Economic Commission for Europe and others. Those nations involved in U4SSC are evaluating their progress associated with smart city objectives and the SDGs.

UN-Habitat

UN-Habitat is the United Nations agency established by the UN General Assembly to promote socially and environmentally sustainable towns and cities. UN-Habitat works with partners to build safe, resilient and sustainable cities. The agency plays a role in implementing SDG 11 and the New Urban Agenda, serving as the custodian agency for 9 of the 15 indicators under SDG 11 and supporting the monitoring and reporting of 4 indicators in other goals. Furthermore, UN-Habitat works worldwide to promote transformative change in cities through knowledge sharing, policy making, technical assistance, and collaborative works. These kinds of help provides developing nations with the guidance needed to integrate smart infrastructure into nations' planning

United States of America

The United States has shown a gradual increase in funding for smart infrastructure, using legislation such as the Infrastructure Investment and Jobs Act (IIJA) to fund smart transportation systems and digital infrastructure. The recent interest in AI and cloud computing has further boosted the investment in data centers, which serves as a core of smart city technologies. However, the United States is grappling with regional disparities in access, which makes the gap between certain regions

and citizens. Therefore, the United States is currently trying to address those challenges through initiatives such as expanding 5G network access to underserved and rural areas.

People’s Republic of China

The People's Republic of China has rapidly increased their investment into smart city infrastructure, guided by the Smart City Pilot Program. The widespread adoption of AI, 5G, and big data has allowed cities like Shenzhen and Hangzhou to organize traffic systems and digital platforms City Brain, which is mentioned above. However, besides these developments China currently faces challenges with digital divide and high expenses. To be specific, it widens the gap between major cities and rural, underserved regions, also requiring continuous maintenance and updating. To address these issues, China is trying to expand smart technologies to underserved regions, and improve data access to vulnerable populations and low-income populations.

Federal Republic of Germany

The Federal Republic of Germany is actively transforming its urban centers through Model Projects Smart Cities policy initiative. By utilizing practical technologies like IoT sensors, artificial intelligence, and digital twins, local cities are improving their traffic flow, energy management, and public waste systems in real time. However, Germany faces challenges, such as navigating strict data privacy regulations (GDPR), controlling long approval processes, and high costs. To address these challenges, the country is actively expanding public-private partnerships (PPP) to help cities easily test and scale smart solutions.

Republic of Singapore

The Republic of Singapore has accelerated their interest in smart city infrastructure under the guidance of Smart Nation initiative. The adoption of advanced technologies such as IoT, ICT, and data analytics has allowed the nation to manage urban traffic through Electronic Road Pricing (ERP) and convey public services through SingPass, which is a digital identity platform. However, Singapore confronts challenges regarding data privacy and high expenses. Specifically, widespread monitoring prompts security concerns, while system maintenance requires ongoing expenses and continuous monitoring. To solve these problems, Singapore is looking forward to fortifying national cybersecurity, collaboration with NGOs, and gradual strategy to smoothly adopt technologies.

Republic of Korea

The Republic of Korea is actively leading the smart city through its data-driven urban policy and digital administration initiative in Seoul. Korea specifically enhances technologies such as IoT sensor network, AI-driven traffic platforms, and multifunctional smart poles to strengthen smart infrastructure. However, Korea is currently facing challenges, such as digital divide, high maintenance costs, and ensuring data privacy promotions, which significantly raises the citizens' concerns. To address these challenges, the nation is actively promoting digital inclusion programs, expanding citizen participation through interactive platforms like Seoul Talk, and sharing data to enable public-private collaboration and innovative local solutions.

Republic of Estonia

Estonia stands as a pioneer in smart city development through its widespread digital governance system and advanced transport infrastructure. Also, Estonia is one of the few nations worldwide with complete digital twin coverage, utilizing an AI-driven platform and on-demand mobile mapping technology to manage real-time data streams. Nevertheless, Estonia continues to encounter challenges, including safeguarding personal data, protecting its extensive systems from cyber attacks, and closing the technology gap between rural and urban regions. To address these challenges, the country is strengthening its X-Road platform to ensure secure data exchange between sectors, reinforcing its cybersecurity framework, and broadening digital access to provide equal benefits for citizens.

Republic of India

India is actively pursuing smart infrastructure development to support its rapid urbanization, with over 600 million people expected to live in cities by 2030, which is mentioned in the report of International Disability and Development Consortium (IDDC). Through the Smart Cities Mission launched in 2015, India has deployed technologies like adaptive traffic systems, IoT-based water monitoring, and renewable-powered smart grids across more than 100 cities. However, India is currently facing challenges, such as ensuring consistent execution quality across such a large number of cities and managing the funding. To address these challenges, the nation is increasingly relying on

technical partnerships and infrastructure consultants to strengthen project management and long-term asset management.

Timeline Of Events

Date	Description of Event
Industrial revolution, 18th century	Rapid industrialization and urbanization create economic growth but also raised an challenges, such as pollution poor sanitation, and unsafe living condition
Los Angeles Urban Data Analysis, 1974	The Los Angeles Community Analysis Bureau uses computer databases and data analysis to actively develop smart infrastructure
Internet of Thing concept introduced, 1999	Kevin Ashton introduces the term Internet of Things, which is the main technology to enhance the smart infrastructure through exchanging data and connected network
X-Road launched in Estonia, December 2001	Estonia introduces X-Road, enabling secure data exchange between government information systems and laying the foundation for digital governance
Songdo smart city emergence, 2003	South Korea begins developing Songdo as a technology oriented urban district integrating ICT, sustainable infrastructure, and advanced urban service
Smart Nation initiative launched in Singapore, 2014	Singapore launches its Smart Nation initiative to use digital technologies to improve public services, infrastructure, transportation, and citizens' quality of life
Smart Sustainable City definition developed, 2015~2016	ITU and UNECE establish an international framework defining smart sustainable cities around ICT, sustainability, quality of life, and efficient urban services

Sustainable Development Goals adopted, September 2015	The United Nations adopts the 2030 Agenda, including SDG 11, which calls for inclusive, safe, resilient, and sustainable cities and communities
New Urban Agenda adopted, October 2016	The United Nation adopts the New Urban Agenda, promoting sustainable urban development and encouraging technology and innovation to address urban challenges
ITU smart sustainable city framework strengthened, 2023	ITU publishes updated requirements for smart cities highlighting ICT, IoT, cybersecurity, sustainability, and citizen-centered urban service

UN Involvement, Resolutions, Treaties and Events

Implementation of the outcome of the United Nations Conference on Human Settlements and strengthening of UN-Habitat, 21 December 2012

- The General Assembly reaffirmed the importance of sustainable human settlements and strengthened the role of UN-Habitat
- The resolution supported international efforts to address urbanization, housing, infrastructure, and sustainable human settlements

Transforming our world: the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development, 25 September 2015

- The United Nations adopted the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development and established 17 Sustainable Development Goals.
- The Agenda provides an international framework for sustainable urban development and encourages the use of technology and innovation to achieve sustainable development.

Science, technology and innovation for development, 27 July 2016

- The Economic and Social Council recognized the importance of science, technology, innovation, and ICT for sustainable development.
- In 2016, the UN Commission on Science and Technology for Development specifically selected Smart cities and infrastructure as one of its priority themes.
- The resolution emphasized the importance of digital ecosystems and technology for development.

New Urban Agenda, 23 December 2016

- The General Assembly endorsed the New Urban Agenda adopted at the Habitat III Conference.

- The Agenda established a global framework for sustainable urban development and emphasized inclusive, resilient, and sustainable cities.

- It encourages governments to use innovation, technology, and improved urban infrastructure to address the challenges of rapid urbanization.

World Summit on the information Society (WSIS), 2003~2005

- The United Nations organized the World Summit on the Information Society to address the global development of information and communication technologies.

- Its outcomes provided an international foundation for later discussions on digital governance and technology-driven development.

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